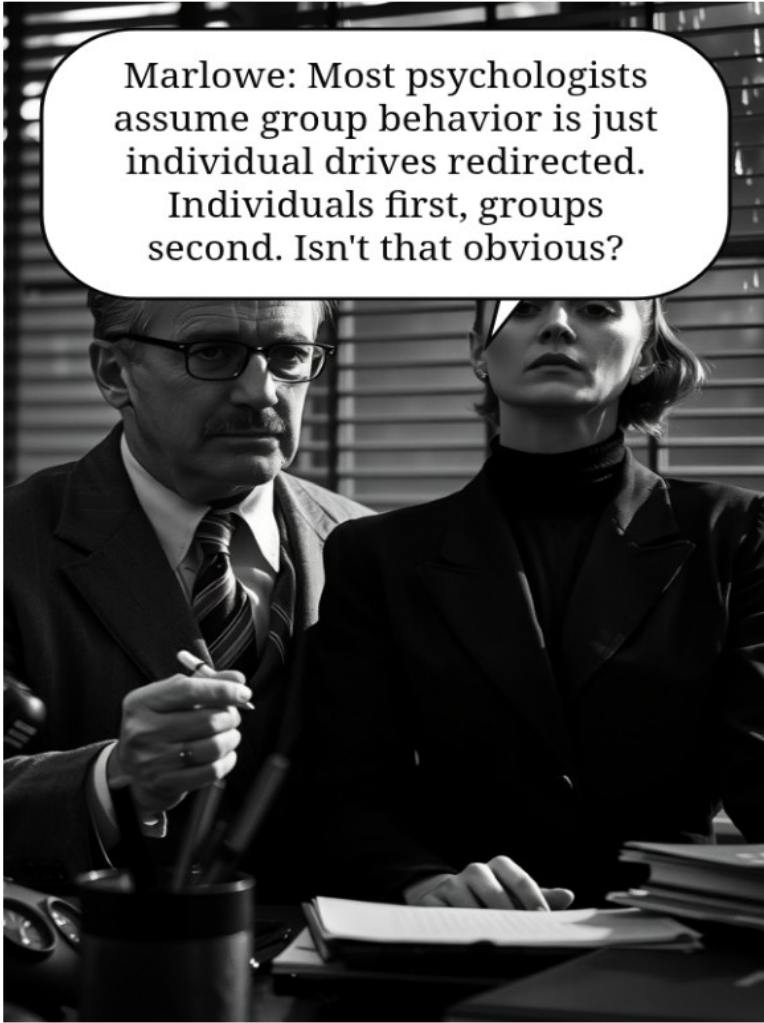
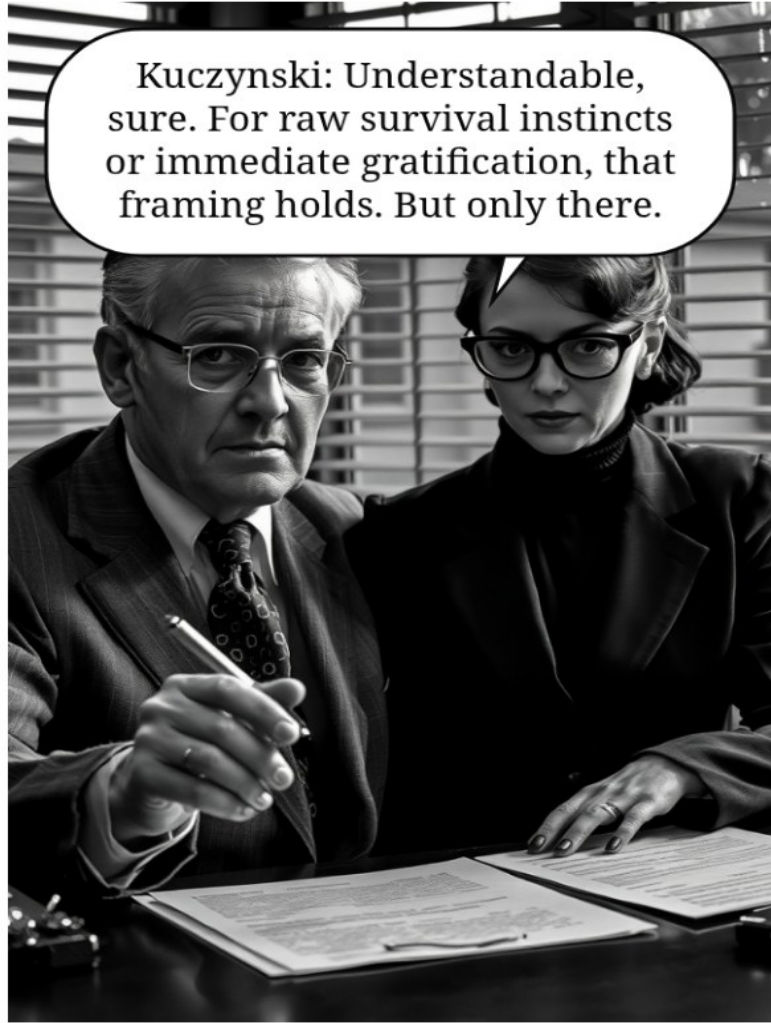


Group Psychology

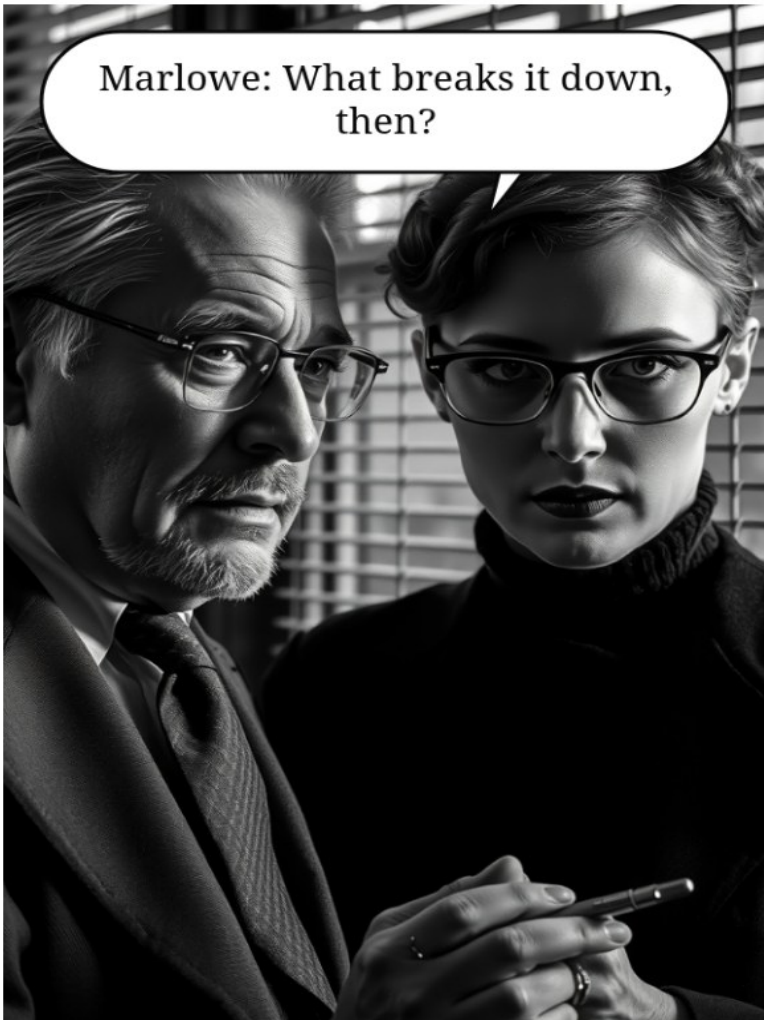
Marlowe: Most psychologists assume group behavior is just individual drives redirected. Individuals first, groups second. Isn't that obvious?



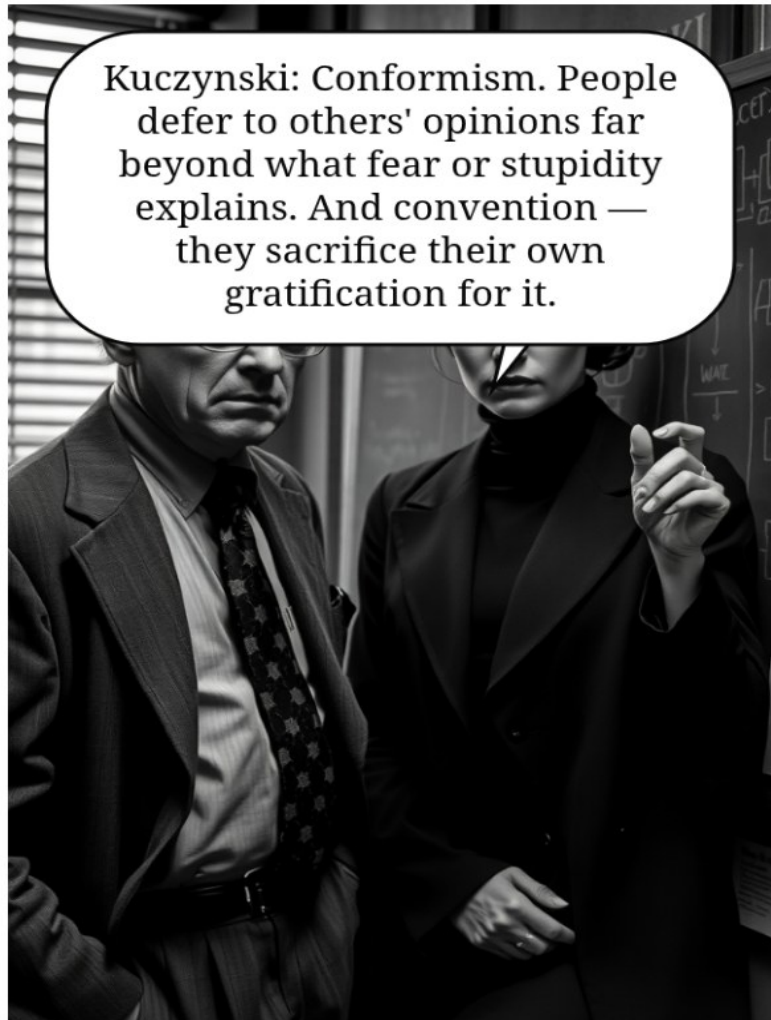
Kuczynski: Understandable, sure. For raw survival instincts or immediate gratification, that framing holds. But only there.



Marlowe: What breaks it down, then?



Kuczynski: Conformism. People defer to others' opinions far beyond what fear or stupidity explains. And convention — they sacrifice their own gratification for it.



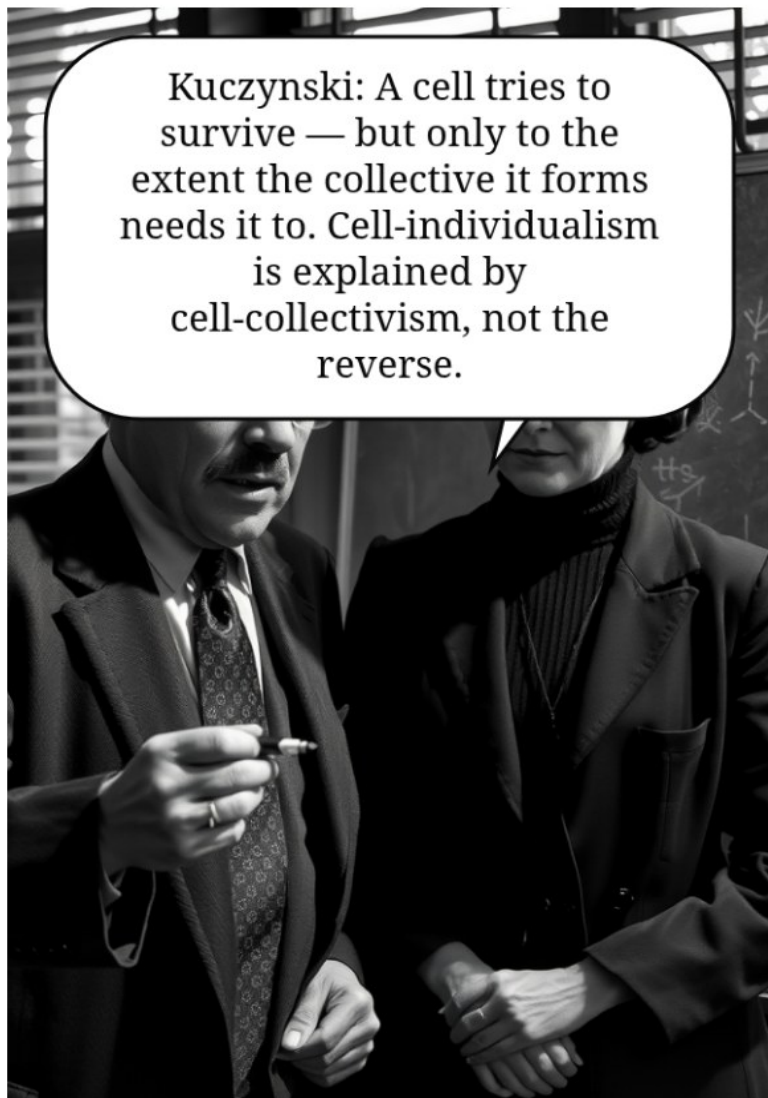
Marlowe: And yet collectives — corporations, academic fields — show more intelligence and moral rigor than most individuals ever manage. How?



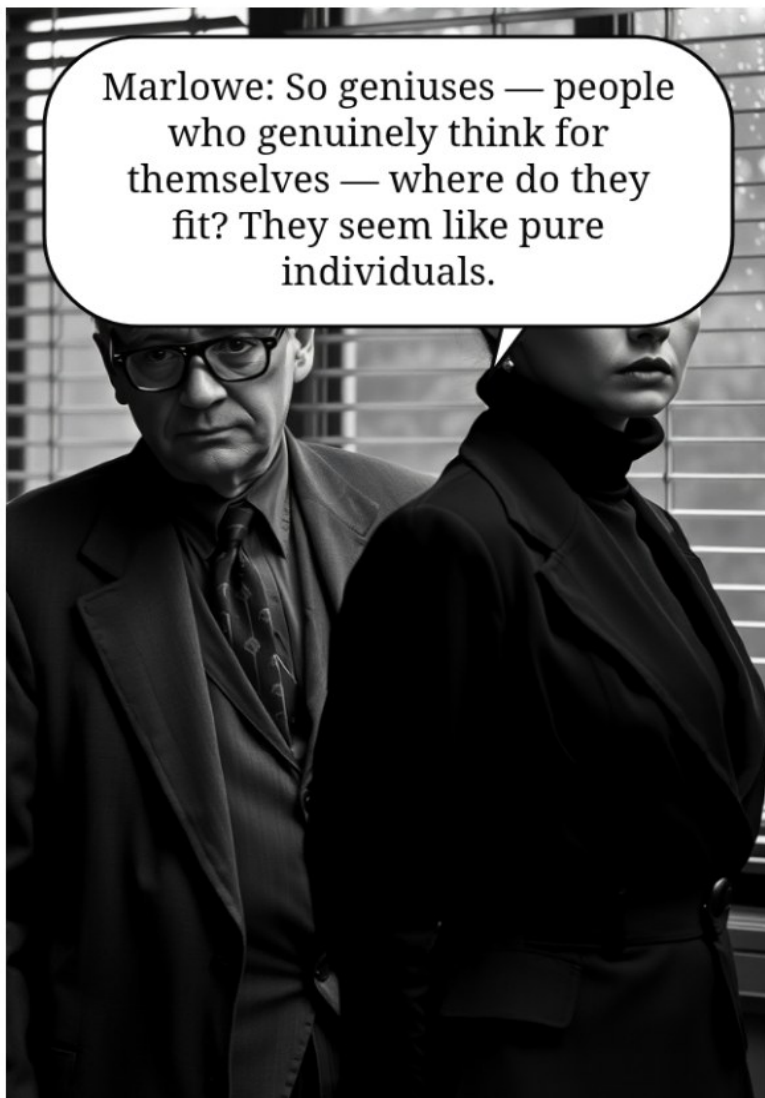
Kuczynski: Because the collective is the primary thing, biologically. Individual choice may be the illusion. Consider a single cell.



Kuczynski: A cell tries to survive — but only to the extent the collective it forms needs it to. Cell-individualism is explained by cell-collectivism, not the reverse.



Marlowe: So geniuses — people who genuinely think for themselves — where do they fit? They seem like pure individuals.



Kuczynski: Limiting cases. Collectives of one, or members with an unusual office inside the collective — wrongly seen as outside it. Even genius is a collective role.



Marlowe: So individual psychology can be reconciled with group primacy — but not the other way around. Groups can't be reduced to armies of self-contained deciders.

